

In their most successful of applications, filter effects blend in with the rest of the image helping to get a combined message across, aimed at getting the viewer more involved in the story being narrated by the photos. Inevitably considered in the planning stages, filter effects are actually a key part of the look of a production and if readily available at your disposal, they prove to be crucial last minute fixes to unexpected problems. It was realised early on that human perception and the photographic processes are quite different, and thus arose the need to use filtration and manipulation techniques to compensate for the human eye and brain's image processing to create, so to speak, more "natural" looking images. Filters in photography are classified according to their use, and this classification is also how we'll take a quick look at the popular options available.

Polarising filters

To generally increase outdoor colour saturation and contrast and decrease reflections, most helpful are polarising filters. And these are also one of the only filters which can't be replicated using digital photo editing. An indispensable tool in every photographer's bag, they require extensive experimentation and testing to develop an intuition for how a polariser might impact a picture. The



Difference using a polarising filter

scientific working of a polariser is fairly simple; it linearly filters out light in a particular direction in the first stage and in the second stage it circularly polarises the light before it enters the camera. What this does basically is reduce reflections from surfaces such as glass and water, and darken a blue sky. It's placed in front of a camera lens and filters out sunlight which has been directly reflected toward the camera at specific angles, thus diffusing the remaining light making it more colourful. However, this requires a longer exposure time since light has partially been discarded.

A polarising filter will be capable of its maximum effect when one's line of sight is perpendicular to the direction of the sun, but this doesn't